

Indian Society and Governance

HM404

Instructor: Dr Vinod Kumar Mall

Email: vinod_mall@daiict.ac.in

Course Placement: This course is an Open elective to 4th year B Tech students.

Prerequisites:

The engineering students of any semester with school level exposure to history, culture and literature will find this course useful. This course will be beneficial to those students who are trying to gain better social awareness about present times and have some interest in finding their positive role in the society. The course will push further their curiosity which they have been able to develop during school and early engineering courses. This course will be very useful to specially those students who chose to go to social sector and use their engineering background to make a difference in the society.

Course Objectives:

1. To understand the evolution of India as a nation with reference to Democracy, Socialism, Equality and Secularism mentioned in Indian Constitution. To get insight into social, philosophical and cultural context in which Indian political system has evolved.
2. To help students to understand the functioning of union, state and local self-government and the associated issues.
3. To provide understanding of National Security Structure, response mechanism and working of security agencies.
4. To give insight into some contemporary social and security problems such as communalism, naxalism and corruption

Course Description:

The course will cover the evolution of India into a plural, multi-cultural and democratic nation over the centuries. It will have a brief introduction to Multi-culturalism, Secularism and Diversity in Indian society. It will describe some important events, personalities and acts which led to India's emergence as democratic, secular, republic. The relationship between Indian culture and its

philosophical traditions with the constitutional principles will be brought out. Relevant portions from Indian and western philosophy will be covered to explain democracy, secularism, socialism and role of religion in the Indian society.

The course will comprise of topics related to making of the post-independence India such as general elections, five year planning, ethnic and religious conflicts along with other social and national issues. Important issues such as Communalism and Left Wing Extremism will be included which are related to governance and security problems facing India. Course will further include structure and functioning of Central and State governments, Panchayat system and local self-government. There will be exposure to governance at grass root and district level.

Course will contain exposure to State police organization, its functioning and Central Police Organizations (CPOs). It will have introduction to National Security Structure and its components. Serious social problems like Communalism and Corruption will be covered which are related to day to day governance. There will be brief exposure to Coastal Security.

Course Objectives:

1. To understand the evolution of India as a nation with reference to Democracy, Socialism, Equality and Secularism mentioned in Indian Constitution. To give social, philosophical and cultural context in which Indian political system has evolved.
2. To help students to understand the functioning of union, state and local self-government and the associated issues.
3. To provide understanding of National Security Structure, response mechanism and working of security agencies.
4. To give insight into some contemporary social and security problems such as communalism, naxalism and corruption

Course Structure:

Classes will be structured in the form of lectures along with seminar format. There will be continuous and in-depth discussion between teacher and students during the class sessions. Presentation by the students will

be encouraged to make them sharpen their articulation skills. Experience sharing by the instructor and students will be integral part of the course structure. The students will be motivated to understand and critically analyse multi-dimensional issues relating to Indian state and equip themselves with a liberal, broad-based understanding of Indian society and polity. This will not only help them to gain knowledge but make them more integral to the society which is continuous evolving and transforming itself through volatile democracy and technology.

Lecture Themes:

The lectures have been designed to give an insight into the characteristics of Indian society, its historical, cultural and philosophical evolution into a modern, secular and democratic nation. India holds unique position in respect of its diversity and composite culture which has deeply impacted on our freedom struggle, making of our constitution and post-independence governance. The lecture's theme will incorporate the socio-political dynamics and government apparatus responsible for realizing the principles enshrined in our constitution. Theme will include the dynamics behind growing communalism facing the nation and ideological resistance movement such as left long extremism in certain parts of the country. Some national security issues will be included in the theme.

Evaluation: Evaluation will be continuous, based on presentations, panel discussions, class tests and assignment. It is proposed to have module-wise evaluation of 4 modules (30%). Term paper writing based on in-depth study/discussions and data collection/survey will be 30%. End term will be of 40% weightage which will have written component.

Learning Outcomes: After completion of the course the student will be able to

- 1 Get a broad-based understanding of Indian society and enable students to relate their theoretical knowledge with social realities on the ground.
2. Understand the evolution of India into modern, secular and democratic republic.
3. Understand the functioning of the government.
4. Have understanding of National Security structure to deal with the security problems being faced by India.

5. Initiate research work relating to governance issues

Reading:

1. Ramchandra Guha – India After Gandhi- History of World's largest democracy, Picador, India, 2008
2. Bina Gupta – An Introduction to Indian Philosophy- Perspectives on Reality, Knowledge and Freedom, Routledge, 2021
3. Ramchandra Guha - Gandhi Before India, Penguin Books, 2013
4. KM Sen – Hinduism, Penguin Books, 2004
5. Ashish Nandy and others – Creating a Nationality, Oxford India Paperbacks, 1997
6. Following websites from two known think tanks will be useful.
 - i <https://www.satp.org>
 - ii <https://www.orfonline.org>